

43.2 "TELL" IN REPORTED SPEECH

In reported speech, "tell" can also be used as the main verb. It must be followed by an object, which shows who someone is talking to.

I **want** to learn to drive.



He { **said**
told me } that he **wanted** to learn to drive.

"Say" does not need to be followed by an object.

"Tell" must be followed by an object.



FURTHER EXAMPLES



She **told me** that she **was** at the party.



She **told me** that she **had** a very stressful job.



He **told us** he **arrived** late to the meeting.



They **told us** they **bought** a new house.



I **told her** that I **went** abroad last year.

"That" can also be left out in reported speech with "told."



We **told them** that we **didn't** want it.

⚠ COMMON MISTAKES "SAY" AND "TELL" IN REPORTED SPEECH

He **said** that he had a fast car. ✓

He **said me** that he had a fast car. ✗

"Said" cannot have an object.

He **told me** that he had a fast car. ✓

He **told** that he had a fast car. ✗

"Told" must have an object.